Multiple ways to demonstrate learning

Can students demonstrate learning in different ways?

RESPECT / ASSESSMENT

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Diverse ways of knowing and demonstrating learning are enabled, not restricted to one mode

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

Teaching is never neutral. Choices about readings, cases, examples, guest speakers, classroom norms and professional pathways tell students whose lives and knowledge are considered normal, legitimate or peripheral. When students cannot recognise themselves or their communities in the discipline, participation can start to feel risky or pointless.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “People like me do not seem to exist in this field.”
- “We only appear when the course is discussing disadvantage or a problem.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Offer equivalent formats where the mode itself is not essential.
- Use common criteria across modes so standards remain visible.
- Explain why flexibility is being offered and what remains constant.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A social science course allows students to present a policy brief as written text, audio or a short recorded presentation using the same rubric.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For this assessment, we aim to allow different ways to demonstrate learning when one mode is not itself the learning outcome. The learning outcomes being assessed are [insert outcomes].

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View the UQ creative assessment design resource

Designing assessment

Creating and using rubrics